PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Mercedes-Benz Europa International Gs

1990s–2001 · 300 GE · G 320 · G 500

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **US VIN and Europa paperwork**
  A real Europa truck has a US VIN and federal compliance, not a foreign VIN cleared later by an independent lab. Match the VIN, the compliance label and any Europa invoices.
- [ ] **Which G 320 engine?**
  1998 was the changeover year, so a G 320 can have the M104 inline-six or the M112 V6. Check the engine code, since the two have different weak points.
- [ ] **M104 head gasket**
  Look under the right rear of the inline-six for oil seeping from the head gasket. Owners say a proper repair, about $2,000 at a dealer in 2002, usually lasts.
- [ ] **Front axle service history**
  Ask when the front knuckles and bearings were last repacked. Europa recommended every 40,000 miles; owners say it's definitely due by 75,000.
- [ ] **Test all three lockers**
  Engage centre, rear and front on loose ground and watch the indicators. Lockers that 'were never used' often don't work.
- [ ] **Ignition and key system**
  German Cars For Sale Blog warns that the electronic ignition (EIS) and smart key fitted to late Europa trucks (around 2000, possibly a year or two earlier) can strand you without warning and are expensive to replace. Make sure every key starts the truck.
- [ ] **Rust from snowy states**
  Scott Brady's 1996 Europa truck had two corrosion spots from its time in the Northeast. Check the tailgate's lower edge, door bottoms, sills and rear frame tubes.
- [ ] **Originality pays**
  Hagerty says enthusiasts will pay up to 30 per cent more for an all-original G. Keep the factory parts if you modify one.

YEARS TO KNOW

1994–1998	BEWARE	M104 G 320s are the ones with the known head-gasket seep; German Cars For Sale Blog calls the head gasket the G 320's only drawback against the 300 GE and G 500
1999–2000	SWEET SPOT	Late Europa G 500s. CarGurus says the very last 1999–2000 G 500s are considered very reliable, and Expedition Portal owners prefer their manual transfer-case lever and sturdier window regulators to the 2002-on trucks'

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Transmission shifter console labelling**
  1992–2001 · NHTSA 01V064
- [ ] **Fuel rollover valve seating**
  1999–2000 · NHTSA 00V188
- [ ] **Front seat-belt reel housing (LWB G 500)**
  1999 · NHTSA 00V070
- [ ] **Passenger airbag labelling (G 320)**
  1997–1998 · NHTSA 01V237

- [ ] **VIN format**
  Bring a Trailer's 2000–2001 Europa G 500s carry 17-character US-format VINs beginning WDBEG42, with the 10th character as the model-year code (Y = 2000, 1 = 2001). The 1998 Europa G 320s listed there show VINs in the European style, beginning WDB463231 (W463 model code). Neither decodes fully in NHTSA's vPIC tool, so lean on paperwork as well.
- [ ] **Compliance label and invoices**
  A real Europa truck has a federal compliance label and Europa sales paperwork, not a foreign VIN cleared later by an independent lab. Match the VIN on the label, the chassis and the invoices.
- [ ] **Recall records**
  Europa filed its own NHTSA recalls under the make 'EUROPA' (e.g. 01V064, covering 1992–2001 trucks). A completed Europa recall in the service file is good evidence of a factory-certified truck.
- [ ] **G 320 engine**
  1998 was the changeover year, so a G 320 can have the M104 inline-six or the M112 V6. Read the engine code rather than trusting the model year.
- [ ] **Europa versus 2002 MBUSA G 500**
  A Europa G 500 has black-painted bumpers, the pre-facelift W210 E-Class steering wheel and cluster, no wheel-mounted radio buttons, older climate controls and a 722.6 automatic without the tip-shift gate.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/g-class/europa/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks